

ED 101: INTRODUCTION TO EDUCATION



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ED-101

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

[Licensing](#)

[About this book](#)

[Chapter 1: Becoming a Teacher](#)

- [1.1: Building a Resume](#)
- [1.2: Professional Organizations \(Joining a Larger Community\)](#)
- [1.3: References](#)

[Chapter 2: Teacher Knowledge](#)

- [2.1: References](#)

[Chapter 3: History of American Education](#)

- [3.1: History of American Education](#)
- [3.2: The Competing Goals of Public Education- A Historical Perspective](#)
- [3.3: References](#)

[Chapter 4: Educational Philosophies](#)

- [4.1: Foundations of Educational Philosophy](#)
- [4.2: Ontological Frameworks of Philosophy](#)
- [4.3: Philosophical Perspective of Education](#)
- [4.4: Educational Psychology](#)
- [4.5: References](#)

[Chapter 5: Ethics and Legal Issues in Education](#)

- [5.1: Ethics](#)
- [5.2: Integrity](#)
- [5.3: References](#)

[Chapter 6: The reflective practitioner](#)

[Chapter 7: Teachers' Purposes and Beliefs](#)

[Chapter 8: Lifelong learning and professional development](#)

[Index](#)

[Glossary](#)

[Detailed Licensing](#)

[Detailed Licensing](#)

Licensing

A detailed breakdown of this resource's licensing can be found in [Back Matter/Detailed Licensing](#).

About this book

Foundations of Education was created as a broad introduction to the teacher education program at SUNY Oneonta. The faculty of SUNY Oneonta designed this book with the intention to give an overview of topics that would be returned to throughout the student's preparatory program. The authors strove to create a reader-friendly overview that would be used as the basis for classroom discussion as they welcomed future educators and asked them to reflect on what kind of teacher they will be.

About our Team

Foundations of Education was designed and developed by the Education Department at SUNY Oneonta in cooperation with the SUNY Oneonta Teaching, Learning, and Technology Center. This project was supported by SUNY OER Services with funds from New York State's 2018-2019 budget allocation for Open Educational Resources.



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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

Chapter 1: Becoming a Teacher

Learning Objectives

- Describe the process of becoming a teacher in Michigan
- Write a draft of the pre-service teacher resume
- Identify Professional Organizations according to Content and Grade Level Specialties

[1.1: Building a Resume](#)

[1.2: Professional Organizations \(Joining a Larger Community\)](#)

[1.3: References](#)

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1.1: Building a Resume

Building a resume is an important task as you join any professional community, teaching or otherwise. A resume is a quick and professional introduction to you and your skills. It allows potential employers and collaborators get to know you. A resume should tell a good story. A *teaching* resume should tell a good story about your professional education and experiences that shape your stance as a qualified educator. It is important to begin shaping your professional teaching resume early in your teacher preparation program. You may then continue adding to and revising the resume as you gain valuable professional experiences by completing and documenting field experience opportunities in the program.

Discussion Questions

- What are the conventions of a teaching resume?
- In what ways do resumes tell a story?
- What makes an educational resume different than other professions?

Sample Resume

BEA A. TEACHER

Local Street Address,

City, State Zip

Permanent Street Address, City, State Zip phone
number • email

OBJECTIVE

To obtain a teaching position at the elementary level in the Oneonta City School District

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Early Childhood/Childhood Education (B-6), Concentration in Biology Month Year

State University of New York (SUNY), College at Oneonta, Oneonta, NY NCATE Accredited

Advanced Regents Diploma Month Year

Burnt Hills-Ballston Lake Senior High School, Burnt Hills, NY

RELATED EXPERIENCE

Teacher, School Name, City, State Month Year – Month Year

- Work with 25 students, K-12, and all ability levels
- Instruction in reading, writing, math, and study skills
- Effectively manage average classroom of 20 students
- Met with parents regarding student classroom behavior

Student Teacher – Kindergarten, School Name, City, State Month Year – Month Year

- Used centers for math, science, social studies, health, and writing
- Implemented a positive discipline plan and phonics instruction with small groups
- Developed thematic unit on plants/gardening around major instructional goals

Student Teacher – Fourth Grade, School Name, City, State Month Year – Month Year

- Created and implemented literature units on density
- Developed and taught writing unit on “why” stories
- Used teacher’s manuals as guideline for teaching math and science
- Modified lesson plans to meet students’ needs required for 504/IEP plans
- Adapted units for time, money, geometry, and weather

Program Assistant, School/Organization Name, City, State Month Year – Month Year

- After school program sponsored by XYZ Central School
- Supervised and managed groups of 15-20 children grades K-5

FIELD EXPERIENCE

Observation/Participation – 200 Hours Year – Year

- Kindergarten Participation, Unadilla Valley Central School, New Berlin, NY
- Pre-Kindergarten, Head Start/Early Head Start Day Care, Oneonta, NY
- Fourth Grade, Commack Road Elementary School, Islip, NY
- First Grade, Wing Elementary School, Islip, NY

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Support Staff, Company Name, City, State Month Year – Month Year

- Various clerical responsibilities, including developed proficiency in all Microsoft Office products

Sales Clerk, Department Store, City, State Month Year – Month Year

- Provided exceptional customer service to approximately 40 individuals each day
- Utilized creativity to design two store displays each month
- Responsible for additional duties in manager’s absence

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

St. Vincent Elementary School, St. Vincent, NY Month Year – Month Year

- Coordinated after school program for 25 children, ages 5 to 8
- Maintained a safe and conducive learning environment

ACTIVITIES

Leadership Institute, SUNY Oneonta, Oneonta, NY Month Year – Month Year

Elementary Education Club, SUNY Oneonta, Oneonta, NY Month Year – Month Year

Professional Memberships

Professional Education Council, SUNY Oneonta, Oneonta, NY Month Year – Month Year

Association for Teachers, SUNY Oneonta, Oneonta, NY Month Year – Month Year

Skills

Foreign Language: Spanish Fluency

Computer Programs: MS Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Access Classroom Technology: ELMO, SmartBoard

MM 08/17

Figure 1. Sample Resume Adapted from Template (All Business Templates, 2017)

Many resources exist on the campus of SUNY Oneonta to assist you in building your resume. The Career Development Center (2019) is available to provide guidance concerning the necessary components and steps for building your resume.

The document is provided by the Career Development Center, specifically for students who are beginning to build their professional resume.

Career Development Center
110 Netzer Admin. Building
(607) 436 -2534

10 Steps to Building A Solid Resume

Students often ask: what should I be doing now to prepare to write my resume when the time comes? Here are some steps that you can take today to make sure that yours will be a resume that will gain the attention of potential future employers:

1. **Establish solid relationships with professors and employers.** Don't be afraid to talk to your professors. They can provide a wealth of information and assistance as you determine your career path. You can also learn a great deal from work supervisors, even in part-time and summer jobs. Some day you will be asking these people to write or give a verbal reference for you; the better they know you, the more qualified they will feel to speak about your skills and abilities.
2. **Set career goals.** As soon as you are ready to do so, it is better to start off in a direction, even if you may need to alter that direction later on. Do some research— talk to professors, advisors, career counselors, professionals in fields of interest, etc.— and then weigh the information you have collected. The suggestions in the remainder of this article will help you as you evaluate your plans and goals.
3. **Join clubs and participate in activities related to your career goals.** There are many clubs and organizations on your campus; some relate to academic majors, others to interest areas. Participating in any of these groups can help you to gain insight into a particular field or investigate your interests and skills. Working with fellow students, faculty advisors, and others you encounter can also provide extremely valuable experience in building teamwork and communication skills, both of which are vital to almost any career you may pursue.
4. **Be selective about part-time and summer employment.** While any job can provide valuable experience, employers are often looking for someone who can demonstrate as many of the necessary skills as possible for their available position. The more relevant experience you have, the better prepared you are for a position in your chosen field. You can also use part-time and summer jobs to “test drive” a career choice you are considering.
5. **Volunteer with an organization or agency where you can gain skills related to your career goals.** Volunteering is another a great way to meet people, gain skills, and find out if a certain career is really a good “fit” for you. There are many wonderful opportunities for volunteering in most communities; showing that you had the initiative to take advantage of this type of experience can be very impressive to future employers. This step is especially important for those students who are limited in their choices of summer and part-time jobs.
6. **Do an internship.** What better way to familiarize yourself with the inner workings of a prospective career field than to do an internship with a company or organization in that field? For many internships, academic credit is obtained through the student's major department. Contact your academic advisor for more information and, if encouraged to locate your own internship, you can contact your college career center for further assistance.
7. **Get good grades.** In almost any career you can imagine, employers are looking for the best and brightest graduates to fill their company's openings. Whether you plan to be a teacher, an accountant, a stockbroker, or a psychologist, the better you have performed in your past “job” (as a student), the better your prospective employers can expect you to perform for them. And if you plan to attend graduate school, a high GPA may be an entrance requirement.
8. **Determine skills and abilities needed to succeed in your career and take every possible opportunity to strengthen them.** Flexibility? Communication? Computer literacy? Initiative? What are the skills you will need to succeed on the job? Look at job descriptions, talk to employers, professors, and those currently employed in your field of choice to find out what you will need to do to succeed in your chosen career. Skills do not magically appear your first day on the job (or during your interview!) but take time and effort to build. Start now with your “job” as a student and practice, practice, practice! Be on time for class, initiate questions or discussions, gain computer skills, and make sure that all work you submit shows your best possible effort.
9. **Start planning early.** As you can see from steps #1 – 8 above, planning and preparing for a career is not something that can be done well during the last semester of your senior year. You can write your resume during that time, but if you want some good,

quality information to put on it, the earlier you start, the better off you'll be.

10. **Visit your college career center.** For the most current information about almost any career field you can imagine, your college career center is the first place you should check. If you need any assistance at all in determining what your career path might be, staff members will be willing to take the time to answer your questions. And when you are ready to write your resume, many career centers offer workshops, written materials, and/or a resume critiquing service to help ensure that your resume is the best possible tool for marketing your skills to employers.

ADDITIONAL RESOURCE

Northland University (2019) has created an excellent guide to creating a resume. This guide is geared toward new educators who wish to build their resumes in order to highlight experience during their programs. This guide is available at <https://my.northland.edu/wp-content/uploads/sites/2/2015/07/Education-Majors-Resume-Guide.pdf>

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1.2: Professional Organizations (Joining a Larger Community)

Professional organizations are essential contributors in assisting educators in developing, building, and sustaining teachers' professional learning networks.

Discussion Questions

Consider the following questions:

- What are your professional organization's belief statements or position statements on teaching
- What journals do your organization publish for practicing teachers?
- What resources do your professional organization provide teachers?
- What special events does your organization hold for teachers?

Professional organizations are important to ongoing professional development and growth. Teachers take advantage of conferences, meetings and opportunities to both mentor and be mentored through the professional organizations for their content areas and/or interest areas.

All professional organizations have web sites that assist in understanding their content, the activities and opportunities they provide to their members, and any publications that the organization may publish for its members. In addition, most professional organizations offer a student rate that can assist in building your resume and networking with like-minded educators. A list of national professional organizations adapted from Masters in Education (2019) appear below.

Professional Organizations by Subject/Concentration Area

- National Council of Teachers of English – NCTE www.ncte.org
- National Science Teachers Association – NSTA www.nsta.org
- National Council for the Social Studies – NCSS <http://www.socialstudies.org/>
- American Council on the Teaching of Foreign Languages – ACTFL www.actfl.org
- American Association of Family and Consumer Science – AAFCS www.aafcs.org
- International Literacy Association – ILA <http://literacyworldwide.org>
- National Council of Teachers of Mathematics – NCTM www.nctm.org/
- Professional Organizations for birth-6th grade practitioners
- Association for Childhood Education International www.acei.org
- Teachers First <https://www.teachersfirst.com/proforgs.cfm>
- Association of American Educators <https://www.aateachers.org/>
- Council for Exceptional Children (CEC), Division for Early Childhood (DEC) <http://www.dec-sped.org/>
- National Association for the Education of Young Children <http://www.naeyc.org/>

In addition to those on the national level, most states will also have professional organizations for various contents and grade levels. These are an excellent way to make contacts with other educators in your state.

Suggested Activities

3.1 Describe the process of becoming a teacher in New York State

3.1 Think – pair – share; outline, discuss and then create a potential timeline for completing your teacher certification process over the next four years.

3.1 In small groups discuss the aspects of the certification process which seem most easily accomplished and those that seem most difficult.

3.2 Create New York State TEACH account

3.3 Write a draft of the pre-service teacher resume

3.4 Identify professional organizations according to content and grade level specialties

1. Locate, research, and join either a local or national organization, preferably related to your content concentration or major that supports students, pre-service, and/or beginning teachers.

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Chapter 2: Teacher Knowledge

Content Knowledge, Pedagogical Content Knowledge, And Curricular Knowledge

If teaching is the highest form of understanding as Aristotle claims, then what are the forms of understanding and how might we develop a framework for articulating this understanding?

This complex understanding is part of the foundational requisites of teacher knowledge. According to Gudmundsdottir & Shulman (1987), there are three main foci that form the foundation of teacher knowledge: Content knowledge, pedagogical content knowledge, and curricular knowledge.

Content knowledge: Teachers need to understand the truth claims of the discipline and interpretive community (professional organization) as well be able to explain why these accepted truth claims are warranted. For example, a Family and Consumer Science teacher would be able to explain what effective resume would look or appropriately tailor a cover letter.

Pedagogical Content Knowledge: Teachers need to understand the teachability of the content. Teachers need to be able to articulate the core topics of the discipline as well as the best examples (and worst) of the key concepts being taught. In addition, teachers should understand when illustrations and representations of key concepts of the discipline will be useful. Teachers need to understand which topics are easier or more difficult for students to learn. Moreover, teachers need to also understand the developmental appropriateness of the topic in relation to their students. For example, an English Language Arts/Reading teacher should be able to evaluate the readability and appropriateness of a certain novel selected for a class and then be able to provide appropriate accommodations for supporting students' comprehension of the text.

Curricular Knowledge: Teachers need to describe the range of programs designed to teach a particular topic or subject at a particular level. Teachers should be able to identify and evaluate the strengths and weaknesses of the instructional materials used to teach particular subjects or topics. For example, math teachers should be able to describe possible concepts that could be on the New York State Regents exam.

In addition to these three foci, a teacher needs to develop a philosophy, or purpose, in which they have an established opinion on the conditions of student learning, their goals for student learning, and how these goals are realized in the classroom. The development of and adherence to a self-identified philosophy of teaching and learning serve as a teacher's guidelines for curricular choices, classroom management strategies, and relationship with students as well colleagues.

Possible Discussion Activity:

- Choose a grade-level content area, explain what would be the best way to teach the content you chose (pedagogical content knowledge)
- Webquest: Go to [EnageNY.org](https://enage.ny.gov/)
 - Research and locate instructional materials for the grade and content you chose for the first discussion that may be used to deliver instruction. Evaluate the possible strengths and weaknesses of the instructional material. Do these correspond to your developing stances on education? If so, why? If not, why? (curricular knowledge)

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

Chapter 3: History of American Education

[3.1: History of American Education](#)

[3.2: The Competing Goals of Public Education- A Historical Perspective](#)

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3.1: History of American Education

Learning Objectives

- Identify important points during the timeline of American Education
- Explain how past events continue to affect current education and educational policy.
- Locate and explain, by referencing examples in a Nation at Risk, the three competing goals of public education: democratic equality, social efficiency, and social mobility.
- Explain the Nation at Risk commission's recommendations.
- Identify two recommendations that affect current educational policies.

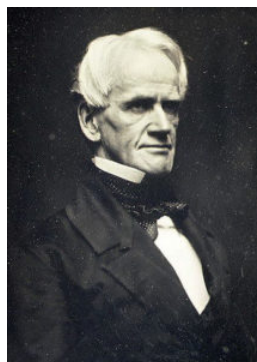


Portrait of Noah Webster

In this chapter, by studying the history of education in America, a better understanding of what currently exists in the educational landscape and why can be achieved. Important innovations have occurred throughout the history of education. In contrast, not every policy or strategy resulted in better education. In the beginning, education was not very widespread and definitely not available to all children.

Thomas Jefferson (1779) had a radical idea that every child should receive an education at the public's expense. The education Jefferson proposed was limited in scope compared with the amount of time spent by a student currently. One of the needs in a democratic society required the ability to read and understand what was read. Jefferson's efforts met with stiff resistance while all efforts to obtain legislative approval failed.

After the Revolution, America needed to separate itself from Britain. Noah Webster called for the elimination of British texts. He wrote the popular Blue Back Speller that Americanized the spelling of many words. Other authors began writing texts that promoted national ideals. Education was being used to make America a unique country.



Daguerreotype of Horace Mann

In the early 1800s Horace Mann began the make-over of the Massachusetts school system as the state superintendent of education. Mann began visiting schools, making reports, and publicly arguing for a free education for all children. In addition, Mann argued for teacher preparation and standardized equipment. His ideas resulted in common schools that were free, had standard

curriculums, were funded by taxes, and gave some local control back to the state. Shortly after Mann's death, he was recognized as a leader in public education and Massachusetts passed public, tax supported, compulsory education.

Slavery had been abolished in Massachusetts early, but African American children were mistreated and harassed in integrated schools leading to segregated schools. A concern about the growth of prejudice generated by segregation in schools and a resentment among African American parents over supporting schools their children could not attend led to unsuccessful petitions to close segregated schools. *Roberts v City of Boston* (1850) argued before the state supreme court failed because the court cited provisions had been made for the African American children to have a school even though it was segregated. In 1855 the state legislature abolished segregation in schools.

Since the beginning of American education, the Protestant faith was a dominant influence with philosophy, holidays, and even prayers. Besides wide spread prejudice against Catholics, they did not want their children exposed to religious beliefs not supported at home. Well attended Great School Debates argued by Cardinal Hughes against a multitude of Protestant ministers occurred. Hughes wanted public funds to start Catholic schools, but the NY City School Board held the line on funding only public schools. The Catholic school system started by breaking away from the public-school system.

At the end of the Civil War, slavery was abolished by the Thirteenth Amendment. Unfortunately, although African Americans were no longer slaves, states of the former Confederacy actively fought integration. Reconstruction ended with the Compromise of 1877 signaling the beginning of the Jim Crow era and the erosion of black civil rights and liberties. By 1896, states had been using the doctrine of separate but equal to justify segregation. Facilities and equipment were vastly inferior for African American students, not equal. *Plessy v. Ferguson* had worked its way up to the US Supreme Court. *Plessy* argued Louisiana's law of separate but equal violated the Thirteenth and Fourteenth Amendments and that segregation labeled African American people as inferior. The Supreme Court ruled that separate but equal did not violate the Constitution.



Brown County's Sod High School

As more and more people migrated to the West for opportunity, state constitutions touted free public educations. So many schools were opening that a new source of teachers was needed. Katherine Beecher established teaching as a female moral calling. Beecher's stand allowed females to journey into the vast expanse of the western plains. With the influx of female teachers, care came into the American classrooms. Students also received moral education through the very popular McGuffey's Readers.

By 1890, America's public schools were educating more students than any other nation on Earth. Unfortunately, many minorities were segregated from public education including, African Americans, Native Americans, and Mexicans. In 1896, John Dewey open his first progressive laboratory in Massachusetts. The progressive philosophy practiced hands-on learning that led to problem solving and critical thinking. Progressivism was popular until World War II.

In 1954, a unanimous decision crafted by Chief Justice Earl Warren in the case of *Brown v. the Topeka Board of Education* heard before the US Supreme Court ended segregation in public schools. Cases from Kansas, Delaware, Washington, DC, South Carolina, and Virginia were combined. In Topeka, each of the students who tried to enroll in a neighborhood school were denied admission. Thurgood Marshall, a future Supreme Court Justice, was one of the lawyers who argued the case for the NAACP. The justices stated that separate facilities are inherently unequal, and that education is a right. Not much changed, the southern states resisted integration, and African American faculty of students who were integrated lost their jobs. As nine students, the Little Rock Nine, tried to integrate a white high school the Alabama National Guard under the direction of the governor prevented the students from entering the school. President Eisenhower federalized the national guard and sent federal troops to enforce the integration in 1959. Finally, when the Civil Rights Act was passed in 1964 stipulating that noncompliance in integration would result in the loss of federal funds, states complied with the Court's order. By 1972, 91% of students attended integrated schools.



In 1958, the Russians launched Sputnik, the world's first satellite. America found itself behind in the resulting space race. The National Defense Education Act called for finding and educating more talent in science, mathematics, foreign languages, and technology. Monetary support was given to states and students. Vocational education received funding, also. A call for experimentation and research in media to improve the presentation of academic subject matter with training given to teachers.

In 1965, Congress passed the Elementary and Secondary Education Act to provide all students a fair and equal opportunity to achieve an exceptional education. Part of the act's goal was to close the achievement gap between poor students and all other students. The three major titles of the act are: Title I – Financial Assistance for the Education of Low-Income Families; Title VI – Aid to Handicapped Children; and Title VII – Bilingual Education Programs, which established the federal fingerprints on education. Congress reauthorized the act in 2001 as the No Child Left Behind Act (NCLB). A major provision added testing of all students in grades 3 through 8 in reading and mathematics with each state setting their own standards. Wide spread criticism caused Congress to reauthorize the act as the Every Student Succeeds Act (ESSA) in 2015. Although the testing continued, accountability was transferred to the states. States submit goals and standards with a plan on how they will be achieved. States also determine the consequences for low-achieving schools (bottom 10%). In addition, all schools are to offer college and career counseling and Advanced Placement courses to all students.



In 1968, Mexican American students from three Los Angeles East Side high schools (Garfield, Roosevelt, and Lincoln) walked out over high dropout rates, lack of college prep courses, rundown schools, and a low number of Mexican American teachers. Student walkouts were a part of a larger scope of activism in the Mexican American community that grew out of treatment as second-class citizens. The walkouts lasted more than a week with student speeches and clashes with the police culminating with students presenting demands at a board of education meeting. The board of education granted the request for smaller class sizes and more bilingual counselors and teachers immediately. A grand jury indicted the activists, the "Eastside 13," but an appeals court vacated the indictment in 1970. Actions taken by the students cultivated a sense of possibility in the community.

By 1971, Detroit and its suburbs presented areas of entrenched segregation as a result of white flight, real estate policies, neighborhood associations, and town policies. A judge approved the Detroit metro plan as a remedy, but the plan failed to garner support from most of the groups involved. In fact, the plan failed to reverse segregation and did not raise the quality of education. When the Supreme Court struck down busing as a means of achieving integration in the *Milliken v Bradley* case, integration was deemed the responsibility of the city. Detroit is still searching for a solution to this thorny issue.

In 1972, Congress passed Title IX of the Education Amendments Act that states: "No person in the United States shall, on the basis of sex, be excluded from participation in, be denied the benefits of, or be subjected to discrimination under any education program

or activity receiving Federal financial assistance” (US Congress). Title IX corrected an oversight by the Civil Rights Act of 1964 which did not prohibit sex discrimination against persons employed at educational institutions. If a school discriminated on the basis of gender, federal funds would be withheld from the school. Enforcement fell to lawsuits brought by the federal government. The act resulted in the creation of public-school sports teams for girls.

Lau v. Nicols (1974) was decided unanimously by the Supreme Court. Supplemental language instruction was denied to most Chinese students who were integrated into the San Francisco public school system; therefore, these students did not receive a meaningful education. In fact, few students throughout the country received supplemental English instruction since funding was limited and participation was voluntary. The Court stated that supplemental instruction was required because the school district received federal funds. The Court argued that a “sink or swim” policy for learning was prohibited. Subsequent decisions required plaintiffs to provide proof of intentional discrimination which weakened the Lau finding.

In 1975, the Education for All Handicapped Children Act was passed by Congress that required “public schools receiving federal funds to provide equal education to students with physical and mental disabilities” (US Congress). To ensure that the education provided students with disabilities closely aligned with the education of non-disabled students, students with disabilities were evaluated and an educational plan with parent input was created. Schools were required to provide procedures for parents to dispute decisions with judicial review as a last resort. The act required disabled students to be placed in the least restrictive environment with the greatest opportunity to interact with non-disabled students. Only when the nature and severity of the disability prevented education in a regular classroom were separate schools allowed.

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3.2: The Competing Goals of Public Education- A Historical Perspective

Frontloading Activity

Before continuing the reading, take some time to review the history of American public education and write on the following questions:

- What are one or two goals of public education over the course of American history?
- Do the original goals of Thomas Jefferson and Horace Mann still inform public policy for education? Why or why not?

David Labaree (1997), an educational historian, argued that there have been three overarching goals of public education in the United States since the inception of public education in the 1800's: 1) democratic equality, 2) social efficiency, and 3) social mobility. A democratic equality goal aims at educating an engaged citizenry capable of actively participating in a democratic society. A social efficiency goal aims at educating young people to help the economic success of the country. Finally, a social mobility goal aims at educating young people in order for people to “gain a competitive advantage in the struggle for competitive social positions” (p. 42). Two of these goals—democratic equality and social efficiency—can be defined as public goods, or goods that benefit society as a whole; whereas the social mobility goal positions education as a private resource, or commodity. Each of these goals, Labaree argued, tacitly guides the direction of public education policy. At times, these three goals compete against the inherent aims of the other goals, i.e., public goods versus private goods. In some cases, such as social mobility, there are internal contradictions, or aporias, within a single goal's overall aims. For example, families with higher socio-economic status tend to work to protect and ensure their children's social status, which creates gatekeeping mechanisms to limit access to educational opportunities. However, families in lower socio-economic strata seek to expand equitable access to educational opportunities in order to help advance the economic and social well-being of their children. In either case, social mobility goals envision education as a private and limited resource.

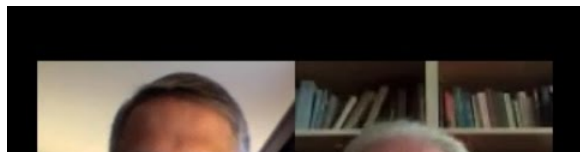
Consolidating Understanding Activity

The following podcast and webinar further elaborate Labaree's model of public education goals as well as describe how each goal competes with one another. As you listen to the first twenty minutes of podcast, paraphrase each of the three goals and give concrete examples of each goal.



A YouTube element has been excluded from this version of the text. You can view it online here: pb.libretexts.org/foundationsofeducation/?p=126

After listening to the previous podcast, watch David Labaree's webinar up to minute 26:20. As you watch, take notes on the ways Labaree elaborates on how the goals compete with one another.



YouTube element has been excluded from this version of the text. You can view it online here: libretexts.org/foundationsofeducation/?p=126

In what ways does each goal compete with one another?

In what ways does the tension between public and private goods manifest themselves in real-world situations?

Take note of the internal contradictions of social mobility goals:

What are the criteria for determining who gets access to certain classes like Advanced Placement?

How do mobility goals manifest themselves in real-world situations?

Review this chapter and videos on the periods of educational history. Return to your original ideas on what you thought were/are the goals of public education in the U.S. Write on the following questions:

- Give one example of each of Labaree's educational goals from this chapter or the linked videos.
- Which of Labaree's goals most resemble your own thesis on the goals of public education?
- Which of Labaree's goals best fits your own personal goal for education as a student? Explain.
- Which of Labaree's goals best fits your emerging philosophy of education? Explain.

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

Chapter 4: Educational Philosophies

Learning Objectives

- Describe different philosophies of education
- Describe characteristics of one philosophy of education
- Connect characteristics of one philosophy of education to instructional methods and classroom management
- Write a brief I-statement on students' emerging philosophy of education
- Differentiate between an educational philosophy and ideology

Pre-Reading Activity

Think and write on the following guiding questions

- What does being teacher mean?
- What are the aspects that make teachers what teachers are?
- What should be taught?
- How should it be taught?
- Why is it important to teach....(insert content)?
- What is knowledge?
- How does knowledge become learned by students?
- What is the relationship between teacher and student?

Whether you are aware or not, you have begun writing philosophical statements about education and being a teacher. After sharing your answers, please do the following:

1. Complete the [Educational Philosophies Self-Assessment Survey](#)
2. Compile your score using [Educational Philosophies Self-Assessment Scoring Guide](#)

What does this survey reveal about your underlining philosophy?

Do you agree or disagree with this assessment? Explain.

What might this survey reveal with your reasons in becoming a teacher?

[4.1: Foundations of Educational Philosophy](#)

[4.2: Ontological Frameworks of Philosophy](#)

[4.3: Philosophical Perspective of Education](#)

[4.4: Educational Psychology](#)

[4.5: References](#)

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4.1: Foundations of Educational Philosophy

A philosophy grounds or guides practice in the study of existence and knowledge while developing an ontology (the study of being) on what it means for something or someone to be—or exist. Educational philosophy, then, provides a foundation which constructs and guides the ways knowledge is generated and passed on to others. Therefore, it is of critical import that teachers begin to develop a clear understanding of philosophical traditions and how the philosophical underpinnings inform their educational philosophies; because, a clear educational philosophy will help guide and develop cohesive reasons for how each teacher designs classroom spaces and learning interactions with both teachers and students. A clear philosophy also frames the curriculum along a spectrum from teacher-centered curriculum to student-centered curriculum to society-centered curriculum.

Over the course of history, philosophy has had several paradigm shifts that influence teaching and learning. Each of these paradigm shifts altered the ontology, epistemology, axiology and school of philosophy, which also shaped what it means to be a teacher within each historical era. While Occidental metaphysical traditions are grounded in the tradition of the Ancient Greeks and the philosophies of Plato and Aristotle, philosophical traditions from the 19th century helped ground the early foundations of educational philosophy and the development of public education in Europe and the United States.

“What does it mean to be?” is the guiding question of ontology, and stemming from one’s stance on this foundational question, a general structure (Table 1) guides an educator’s general stance on epistemology, axiology, educational philosophy, and psychological orientations; these, then, inform, or should inform, an educator’s choice of instructional methods and classroom management techniques.

Visual Literacy Activity

Rather than focusing on the difficult and the abstract, let’s focus on the concrete and work our way up. Use Table 1 to help answer the following questions:

1. Choose one instructional activity from Table 1 you feel is an effective method of instruction. Explain why?
2. Choose one classroom management technique from Table 1 you feel is an effective classroom management technique. Explain why?
3. Do your two choices align in a similar area of the outlined shape? If so, explain why they might align? If not, explain why they might not align.
4. Trace your two choices up the table to psychological orientations, educational philosophy, axiology, epistemology, and ontology. Does this line align with where you placed on the philosophy of education assessment survey? If so, you are beginning to construct an outline for your philosophy of education. If not, you may need to explore more on what you feel is important in being a teacher. In either case, you will use the rest of this chapter to help guide your (re)developing philosophy of education.

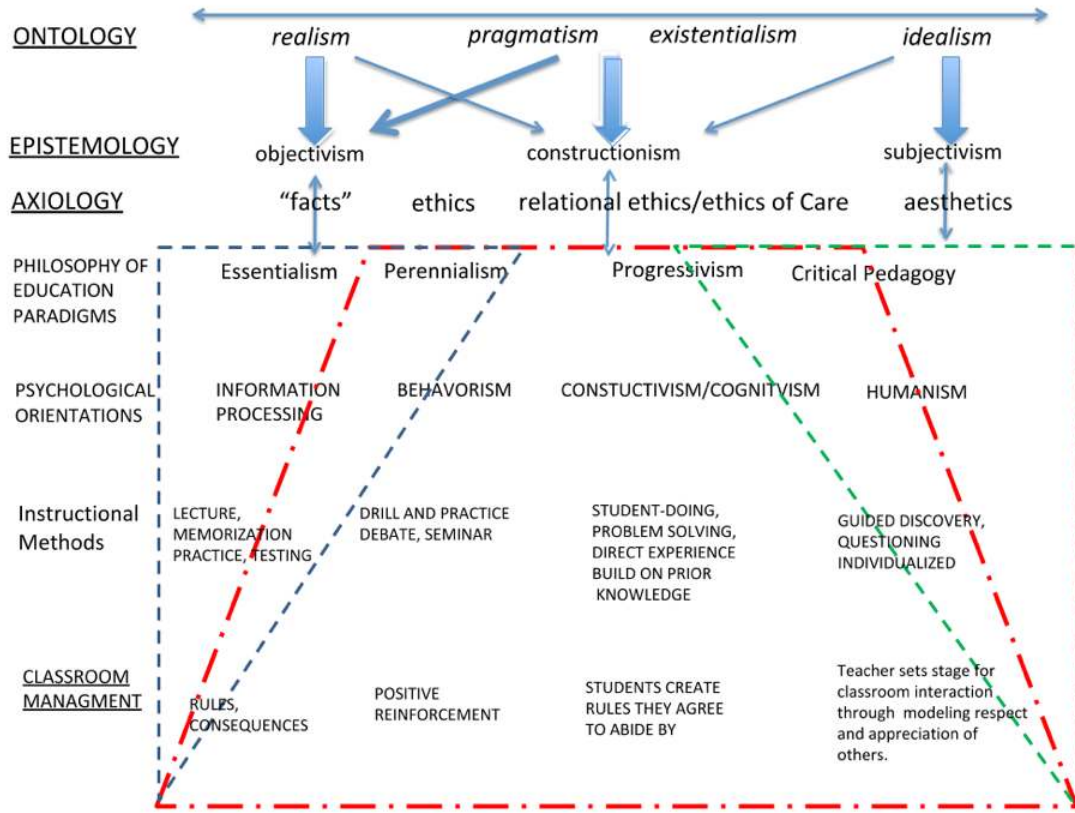


Table 1: Philosophies of Education Matrix

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4.2: Ontological Frameworks of Philosophy

Generally, there are four ontological perspectives that frame schools of educational philosophy. Two ontological frameworks, idealism and realism, stem from Ancient Greece. The Ancient Greek philosopher Plato developed the tradition of idealism; whereas, Aristotle, Plato's student, formed an antithetical ontology of realism. Progressivism and existentialism grew from the philosophical remnants of the Age of Enlightenment in the 19th century. Pragmatism formed within the United States during the late 1800s; at the same time, existentialism developed as a continental philosophy in Europe. While the early public education system in United States was guided by idealism and realism, pragmatism and existentialism has served as the influential foundations of 20th and 21st century educational philosophies.

Idealism



For idealists, ideas are the only true reality. Conscious reasoning is the only way to locate what is true, beautiful, and just. Plato founded Idealism and outlined its tenets in his book *The Republic*. For Plato, there are two worlds. The first world is home of the spiritual or mental world where universal ideas and truth were permanent; this world can only be found through conscious reasoning. The second world is the world of appearances and imperfection; a world experienced through sensory experiences of sight, sound, touch, smell, and taste. Plato outlines this duality between the two worlds in “The Allegory of the Cave.” In this famous allegory, people are chained against walls with a fire behind them. What the people perceive as real are only shadowed projections on the wall of cave. If one was to break free, leave the cave, and discover the sun, this new “realm” would discover the true source of everything that was previously known. It would be the realm of pure fact and form. This is the source of all that is real. The real world is just an imperfect projection of these ideas, forms, and truth.

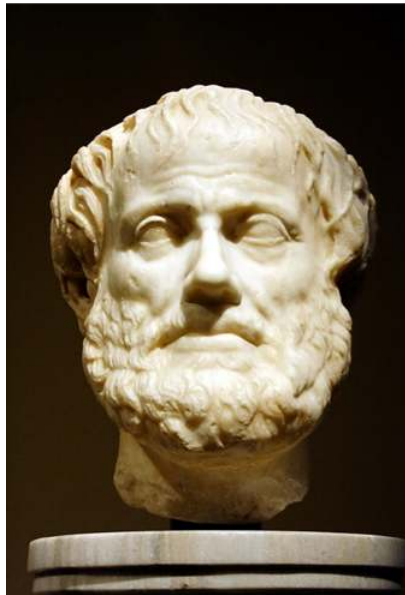
Almost two centuries later, Dutch philosopher Renè Descartes would shift Platonic Idealism toward mind-body dualism with his famous phrase “Cogito, ergo sum (I think; therefore, I am).” For Descartes, the only proof of his existence is his thinking—a thinking being. Like Plato, Descartes outlined a rationale for why perceptions are unreliable, and the external world is illusory. Only through rationale deduction, could one obtain truth. While Plato outlined a dualism between two separate worlds, Descartes established an Idealism founded on mind-body dualism where the thinking mind is given privilege over the physical body and external world. This dualism would heavily influence philosophy and educational philosophy well into the 20th century.

Teaching, for Idealists, focuses on moral excellence that will benefit society. Students should focus on subjects of the mind like literature, history, and philosophy. Students will demonstrate understanding through participation in lecture and through Socratic dialogues which engage students in introspection and insight that bring to conscious the universal forms and concepts.

Key philosophers:

Plato, Descartes

Realism



“viena-Wien. Kunsthistorisches Museum. Cap d’Aristotil. Copia romana d’un original grez. Ca. 320 Dc.” by Pilar Torres

Realism’s central tenet is based on a reality, or external universe, independent from the human mind. Aristotle, Plato’s student, contradicted his teacher’s Idealist philosophy and formulated a philosophy on determining truth through observation. Reality can be truly understood by careful observation of all the data. Because of his emphasis on careful observation, Aristotle is often referred as the Father of the Scientific Method. Through logic, humans can reason about the physical universe. Essences of things or substances, therefore, can be determined by examination of the object or substance. Aristotle’s logic, then, emphasizes induction as well as deduction, and the real world can be determined through both.

During the Enlightenment, Common Sense Realism began to counter the Idealism of Descartes. Rather than the skepticism of the external world espoused by Idealists, the Common Sense Realists, like John Locke, argue that ordinary experiences intuit a self and the physical world without the skepticism of the real world outside the mind. This Realism would influence the development of Empiricism and Pragmatism later in the Enlightenment.

For realists, teaching methods should focus on basic skills and memorization and mastery of facts. Students demonstrate content mastery of these skills through critical observation and applied experimentation.

Pragmatism

Like Realism, Pragmatism requires empirical observation of the real world; however, unlike Realism and Idealism, the real world is not an unchanging whole, but is evolving and changing according to how thought is applied into action towards a problem. Thought cannot or should not describe or represent reality, but rather, should be applied by the practical applying thoughts and experiences to problems that arise. The universe, then, is always evolving according to new applied thoughts turned into actions. Pragmatism’s founder Charles Sanders Pierce posits thought must produce action towards an ever-changing universe.

John Dewey, the founder of Progressivism, believed that experience is central to explaining the world; moreover, experience is what is needed to be explained. One needs practical experiences and uses explanations to find models that would best fit any given problem or situation. As new experiences and explanations arise, reality will evolve or change to new situations and problems.

Pragmatists focus on hands-on, experiential learning tasks such as experimenting, and working on projects in groups. Students will demonstrate understanding through applied learning tasks to concrete problems or tasks.

Key philosophers:

Charles S. Pearce, William James, John Dewey

Existentialism grew from the continental philosophies forming in Europe during the 19th and early 20th century, most notably hermeneutic phenomenology—the examination of lived-experience. Hermeneutic phenomenology and existentialism countered the dualisms inherent in both Idealism and Realism. The world does not have any meaning outside human existence within a world. The mind/body or mind/physical world duality and cannot have any meaning without a human being actively absorbed in the world. Jean Paul Sarte posited that “existence precedes essence”, which means one’s existence comes before the nature, or fact, of a thing. This means that individual human beings are free to determine their own meaning for life and do not possess any inherent identity different than one the individual chooses or creates.

Existentialists position the individual as responsible for their own being, or existence. “Who am I? What should I do?” become central questions for an individual’s project in being. If one identifies with being a teacher, or any other identity like being a parent, then one must evaluate what does one who teaches (or any other identity) really do? After thoughtful and careful reflection, one must choose to authentically do the project of being a teacher (or any other identity). Acting in accordance to your chosen beliefs and values despite social pressures is the way to have an authentic existence; however, acting or adopting false values based on social pressures would be acting in “bad faith” and one would be living in inauthentic existence according to Sartre.

In educational settings, Existentialists focus on giving students personal choice where they must confront others’ views in order to clarify and develop authentic actions in terms of the students’ developing identities. Existentialists have difficulty positioning students as objects to measured, tracked, or standardized. Teachers who adhere to an Existentialist ontology create activities to guide students to self-direction and self-actualization.

Key philosophers:

Søren Kierkegaard, Jean Paul Sartre, Simone de Beauvoir

Axiology

Axiology is the study of value or concepts of worth. There are two main axiological stances: one that explores ethics and what is right and wrong; and the other deals with aesthetics and what is beautiful. While there are two main stances of axiology between ethics and aesthetics, axiology can be further refined. Analytical philosophy, or logical positivist, attempts to measure value based on the mathematics of value in an attempt to determine objective facts on why something has value. Normative ethics focuses on how a person determines basic ethical or moral standards. Ethics of care, unlike normative ethics, focuses on relational aspects between humans and a person’s identity that can be defined by one’s individual relations with others. Lastly, aesthetics is related to the philosophy of art. A person focusing on aesthetics puzzles how one experiences or determines beauty, ugliness, form, and the sublime.

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4.3: Philosophical Perspective of Education

There are four philosophical perspectives currently used in educational settings: essentialism, perennialism, progressivism, and social reconstructionism/critical pedagogy. Unlike the more abstract ontology and axiology, these four perspectives focus primarily on what should be taught and how it should be taught, i.e. the curriculum.

Essentialism

Essentialism adheres to a belief that a core set of essential skills must be taught to all students. Essentialists tend to privilege traditional academic disciplines that will develop prescribed skills and objectives in different content areas as well as develop a common culture. Typically, essentialism argues for a back-to-basics approach on teaching intellectual and moral standards. Schools should prepare all students to be productive members of society. Essentialist curricula focuses on reading, writing, computing clearly and logically about objective facts about the outside real world. Schools should be sites of rigor where students learn to work hard and respect authority. Because of this stance, essentialism tends to subscribe to tenets of Realism. Essentialist classrooms tend to be teacher-centered in instructional delivery with an emphasis on lecture and teacher demonstrations.

Key theorists:

William Bagley, E.D. Hirsh Jr.

Perennialism

Perennialism advocates for seeking, teaching, and learning universal truths that span across historical time periods. These truths, Perennialists argue, have everlasting importance in helping humans solve problems regardless of time and place. While Perennialism resembles essentialism at first glance, perennialism focuses on the individual development of the student rather than emphasizing skills. Perennialism supports liberal arts curricula that helps produces well-rounded individuals with some knowledge across the arts and sciences. All students should take classes in English Language Arts, foreign languages, mathematics, natural sciences, fine arts, and philosophy. Like Essentialism, Perennialism may tend to favor teacher-centered instruction; however, Perennialists do utilize student-centered instructional activities like Socratic Seminar, which values and encourages students to think, rationalize, and develop their own ideas on topics.

Key theorists:

Robert Hutchins, Mortimer Adler

Progressivism



Progressivism focuses its educational stance toward experiential learning with a focus on developing the whole child. Students learn by doing rather than being lectured to by teachers. Curriculum is usually integrated across contents instead of siloed into different disciplines. Progressivism's stance is in stark contrast to both Essentialism and Perennialism in this manner. Progressivism follows a clear pragmatic ontology where the learner focuses on solving real-world problems through real experiences. Progressivist classrooms are student-centered where students will work in cooperative/collaborative groups to do project-based, expeditionary, problem-based, and/or service-learning activities. In progressivist classrooms, students have opportunities to follow their interests and have shared authority in planning and decision making with teachers.

Key theorists:

Key theorists:
John Dewey, Maria Montessori

Social Reconstructionism & Critical Pedagogy



Social reconstructionism was founded as a response to the atrocities of World War II and the Holocaust to assuage human cruelty. Social reform in response to helping prepare students to make a better world through instilling democratic values. Critical pedagogy emerged from the foundation of the early social reconstructionist movement. Critical pedagogy is the application of critical theory to education. For critical pedagogues, teaching and learning is inherently a political act and they declare that knowledge and language are not neutral, nor can they be objective. Therefore, issues involving social, environmental, or economic justice cannot be separated from the curriculum. Critical pedagogy's goal is to emancipate marginalized or oppressed groups by developing, according to Paulo Freire, conscientização, or critical consciousness in students. Critical pedagogy de-centers the traditional classroom, which positions teacher at the center. The curriculum and classroom with a critical pedagogy stance is student-centered and focuses its content on social critique and political action.

Key theorists:

Paulo Freire, bell hooks (note: bell hooks intentionally does not capitalize her name, which follows her critical stance that language, even how we write one's own name, is political and ideological.)

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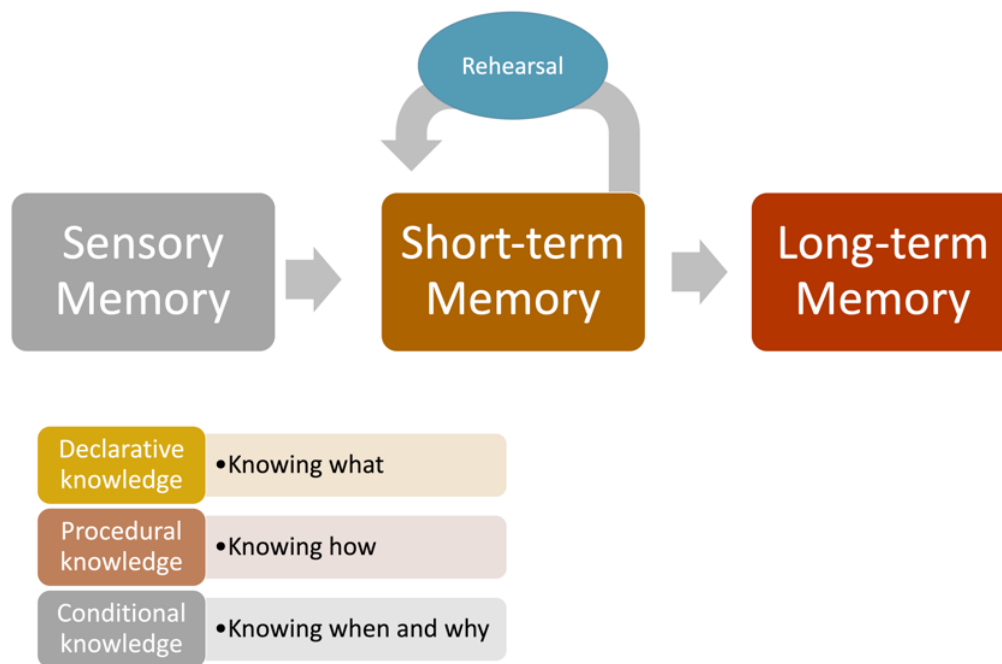
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4.4: Educational Psychology

Educational psychology focuses on how learning occurs; however, like educational perspectives and axiology, there are differing positions in educational psychology that can be traced back to ontological stances. There are four main psychology stances on human development and learning that inform education: information processing, behaviorism, constructivism / cognitivism, and humanism.

Information Processing



Information processing theorists typically equate the human mind as analogous to computer processing. The mind uses hierarchical structures where a learner processes knowledge and ideas in the mind by attending, receiving, processing, storing, and retrieving knowledge from memory. All knowledge has three aspects: declarative, procedural, or conditional knowledge. Declarative knowledge is the knowing of this or that, e.g., penguins have feathers or trees grow by converting carbon dioxide and sunlight into oxygen (photosynthesis). Procedural knowledge is the knowing how to do things or the steps/strategies involved in how to do things, e.g., the steps involved in multiplying mixed numbers or the best ways to make a tuna fish sandwich. Conditional knowledge involves knowing the when and the why to apply the other two types of knowledge, e.g., readers skim newspapers to get the gist, but apply close reading to literature or difficult texts to develop deeper understandings.

Key theorists:

John Atkinson, Richard Shiffrin

Behaviorism

Unlike the information processing stance, behaviorism is not concerned with internal thought processes because they cannot be observed. Environment and other external forces shape one's behavior. Learning occurs when conditioned by external stimuli with reinforcement, positive or negative, from others in addition to feedback from outside objects. The teacher aids students in learning by conditioning them to achieve desirable behaviors through careful observation and applying the appropriate reinforcers for the desired behavior. Learning, then, comes through repetition and meaningful connection through reinforcement. Reinforcers take shape in different ways: grades, stickers, candy, praise, or negative reinforcers that will remove positive reinforcers.

Key theorists:

Constructivism / Cognitivism

Constructivism or cognitivism positions students as active learners that construct their own understandings through active engagement with outside interaction with people, objects, places, and events with reflection on the experience. Learning occurs when a learner comes in conflict with what one knows or believes, which causes an imbalance and a quest on the learner to restore cognitive equilibrium. Learners organize their understandings into organized structures or schemas. When new information is presented, learners must modify the structures or schemas to accommodate and assimilate the new knowledge. Social constructivists focus on the shared, social construction of knowledge by learning a skill or concepts with more experienced learners until one can do the skill or apply the concepts independently, which is referred to by educators as the Zone of Proximal Development (Vygotsky, 1978).

Key theorists:

Jean Piaget, Lev Vygotsky

Humanism

Humanism views these as essential to being human: children are inherently good, humans have free will, humans have a moral conscience, humans can reason, and humans have aesthetic discernment. Learning and understanding are developed through sensual experience, which is gradual and organic in human development. Humanists position students to be in control of their own learning; therefore, students are given a lot of autonomy, choice, and responsibility in the learning environment. Humanism positions students to become self-reliant, life-long learners that are engaged through intrinsic motivation to learn new ideas. Recent iterations of humanism focus on the social and emotional well-being of children in addition to cognitive abilities of children.

Key theorists:

Carl Rogers, Harold C. Lyon Jr.

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Vygotsky, L. S. (1978). Mind in society: The development of higher psychological processes (A. R. Luria, M. Lopez-Morillas & M. Cole [with J. V. Wertsch], Trans.) Cambridge, Mass.: Harvard University Press. (Original work [ca. 1930-1934])

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

Chapter 5: Ethics and Legal Issues in Education

Learning Objectives

- Identify the importance of ethics and the ethical practices of teachers.
- Recognize the responsibilities of teachers as role models.
- Determine individual values and code of ethics in becoming a teacher.
- Compare the New York State Code of Ethics for Educators with the National Education Association (NEA) Code of Ethics.
- Explain why integrity is an essential disposition for teachers.
- Identify liability of teachers concerning copyright laws, mandated reporting and academic freedom.
- Explain the FERPA law
- Identify landmark legal cases in education and their importance in students' rights in schools.

| *What the teacher is, is more important than what he teaches -Karl Meninge*

Teachers as Professional Role Models

Teachers are important role models for their students both in and out of the classroom. Whether teachers are in school or involved in community functions, there are high standards of behavior expected of them. What is meant by the term professionalism? The term professionalism relates to a certain level of degree, skill or expertise in one's specialized area. Indeed, teachers must obtain schooling, required clinical experience and certain tests in order to enter the field of teaching. In addition to this level of knowledge, teachers must demonstrate integrity, impartiality and ethical behavior in the classroom and in their conduct with parents and coworkers. Teachers must model strong character traits, such as reliability, honesty, respect, lawfulness, patience, fairness, responsibility and collaboration.

In Loco Parentis translates to "in place of parent". Historically schools are basically responsible for students while in the hands of teachers. Therefore, teachers have a great deal of responsibility for the welfare of their students.

[5.1: Ethics](#)

[5.2: Integrity](#)

[5.3: References](#)

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5.1: Ethics

Ethics is defined as the discipline of dealing with what is good and bad with moral duty and obligation. As students who will be entering the teaching profession in the next few years, it is imperative to understand that there is a code of ethics that you are expected to follow. Teachers are often held to higher standards than other professions, both in their classrooms and in their personal lives. Teachers are expected to be fair to all their students, not impose their personal views and not abuse their powers as educators. We will examine both the New York State and the National Educator's Association Code of Ethics to get a better understanding of these expectations. These codes of ethics for teachers are designed to protect the rights of all students. The teaching profession requires that individuals be excellent ethical role models.

As a pre-service teacher it is also important to reflect on your own set of values and beliefs. Consider how you will interact with students, manage classroom behavior and assess students' progress. This is just a small part of an educator's duties. The behaviors allowable in your college years may not be acceptable as a new teacher. Everything from the way you dress and speak to how you engage in social media are closely securitized as a teacher. You need to be very conscientious of your appearance, attitudes and behaviors. Teachers are expected to have high ethical standards all the time, both in and out of the classroom.

Activity

- After reading the New York State Code of Ethics for Educators, summarize the six principles.
- Compare New York State Code of Ethics with NEA Code of Ethics. Compare and contrast the similarities and differences.
- List your own values and code of ethics in becoming a teacher.
- Define integrity and explain why it is an essential disposition for teachers.

Teachers, like other professions, are expected to follow a code of ethics to guide and inform their behavior and decision-making.

The National Education Association's preamble for its code of ethics:

"The Educator, believing in the worth and dignity of each human being, recognizes the supreme importance of the pursuit of truth, devotion to excellence, and nurture of the democratic principles. Essential to these goals is the protection of freedom to learn and to teach and the guarantee of equal educational opportunity for all. The educator accepts the responsibility to adhere to the highest ethical standards."

NYSED Code of Ethics

New York State Code of Ethics for Educators

Statement of Purpose

The Code of Ethics is a public statement by educators that sets clear expectations and principles to guide practice and inspire professional excellence. Educators believe a commonly held set of principles can assist in the individual exercise of professional judgment. This Code speaks to the core values of the profession. "Educator" as used throughout means all educators serving New York schools in positions requiring a certificate, including classroom teachers, school leaders and pupil personnel service providers.

Principle 1: Educators nurture the intellectual, physical, emotional, social, and civic potential of each student.

Educators promote growth in all students through the integration of intellectual, physical, emotional, social and civic learning. They respect the inherent dignity and worth of each individual. Educators help students to value their own identity, learn more about their cultural heritage, and practice social and civic responsibilities. They help students to reflect on their own learning and connect it to their life experience. They engage students in activities that encourage diverse approaches and solutions to issues, while providing a range of ways for students to demonstrate their abilities and learning. They foster the development of students who can analyze, synthesize, evaluate and communicate information effectively.

Principle 2: Educators create, support, and maintain challenging learning environments for all.

Educators apply their professional knowledge to promote student learning. They know the curriculum and utilize a range of strategies and assessments to address differences. Educators develop and implement programs based upon a strong understanding

of human development and learning theory. They support a challenging learning environment. They advocate for necessary resources to teach to higher levels of learning. They establish and maintain clear standards of behavior and civility. Educators are role models, displaying the habits of mind and work necessary to develop and apply knowledge while simultaneously displaying a curiosity and enthusiasm for learning. They invite students to become active, inquisitive, and discerning individuals who reflect upon and monitor their own learning.

Principle 3: Educators commit to their own learning in order to develop their practice.

Educators recognize that professional knowledge and development are the foundations of their practice. They know their subject matter, and they understand how students learn. Educators respect the reciprocal nature of learning between educators and students. They engage in a variety of individual and collaborative learning experiences essential to develop professionally and to promote student learning. They draw on and contribute to various forms of educational research to improve their own practice.

Principle 4: Educators collaborate with colleagues and other professionals in the interest of student learning.

Educators encourage and support their colleagues to build and maintain high standards. They participate in decisions regarding curriculum, instruction and assessment designs, and they share responsibility for the governance of schools. They cooperate with community agencies in using resources and building comprehensive services in support of students. Educators respect fellow professionals and believe that all have the right to teach and learn in a professional and supportive environment. They participate in the preparation and induction of new educators and in professional development for all staff.

Principle 5: Educators collaborate with parents and community, building trust and respecting confidentiality.

Educators partner with parents and other members of the community to enhance school programs and to promote student learning. They also recognize how cultural and linguistic heritage, gender, family and community shape experience and learning. Educators respect the private nature of the special knowledge they have about students and their families and use that knowledge only in the students' best interests. They advocate for fair opportunity for all children.

Principle 6: Educators advance the intellectual and ethical foundation of the learning community.

Educators recognize the obligations of the trust placed in them. They share the responsibility for understanding what is known, pursuing further knowledge, contributing to the generation of knowledge, and translating knowledge into comprehensible forms. They help students understand that knowledge is often complex and sometimes paradoxical. Educators are confidantes, mentors and advocates for their students' growth and development. As models for youth and the public, they embody intellectual honesty, diplomacy, tact and fairness. (New York State Education Department, 2017).

NEA Code of Ethics

PRINCIPLE I

Commitment to the Student

The educator strives to help each student realize his or her potential as a worthy and effective member of society. The educator therefore works to stimulate the spirit of inquiry, the acquisition of knowledge and understanding, and the thoughtful formulation of worthy goals.

In fulfillment of the obligation to the student, the educator—

1. Shall not unreasonably restrain the student from independent action in the pursuit of learning.
2. Shall not unreasonably deny the student's access to varying points of view.
3. Shall not deliberately suppress or distort subject matter relevant to the student's progress.
4. Shall make reasonable effort to protect the student from conditions harmful to learning or to health and safety.
5. Shall not intentionally expose the student to embarrassment or disparagement.
6. Shall not on the basis of race, color, creed, sex, national origin, marital status, political or religious beliefs, family, social or cultural background, or sexual orientation, unfairly—
 - a. Exclude any student from participation in any program
 - b. Deny benefits to any student
 - c. Grant any advantage to any student

7. Shall not use professional relationships with students for private advantage.
8. Shall not disclose information about students obtained in the course of professional service unless disclosure serves a compelling professional purpose or is required by law.

PRINCIPLE II

Commitment to the Profession

The education profession is vested by the public with a trust and responsibility requiring the highest ideals of professional service.

In the belief that the quality of the services of the education profession directly influences the nation and its citizens, the educator shall exert every effort to raise professional standards, to promote a climate that encourages the exercise of professional judgment, to achieve conditions that attract persons worthy of the trust to careers in education, and to assist in preventing the practice of the profession by unqualified persons.

In fulfillment of the obligation to the profession, the educator—

1. Shall not in an application for a professional position deliberately make a false statement or fail to disclose a material fact related to competency and qualifications.
2. Shall not misrepresent his/her professional qualifications.
3. Shall not assist any entry into the profession of a person known to be unqualified in respect to character, education, or other relevant attribute.
4. Shall not knowingly make a false statement concerning the qualifications of a candidate for a professional position.
5. Shall not assist a noneducator in the unauthorized practice of teaching.
6. Shall not disclose information about colleagues obtained in the course of professional service unless disclosure serves a compelling professional purpose or is required by law.
7. Shall not knowingly make false or malicious statements about a colleague.
8. Shall not accept any gratuity, gift, or favor that might impair or appear to influence professional decisions or action.

(Adopted by the NEA 1975 Representative Assembly (National Education Association, 1975).

It is important that you look closely at the expectations this college requires of you while an education major. Professional dispositions associated with you as a pre-service teacher are noted below. Please review these dispositions and reflect on responsibilities you have as an education major. These dispositions are part of the rubric that SUNY Oneonta will evaluate you throughout the program.

SUNY ONEONTA – DIVISION OF EDUCATION

The Division of Education at SUNY Oneonta is committed to preparing educators who not only possess content knowledge but also conduct themselves professionally through the expression of appropriate professional dispositions. As defined by the Interstate Teacher Assessment and Support Consortium (InTASC), dispositions are the “habits of professional action and moral commitments that underlie the performances play a key role in how teachers do, in fact, act in practice” (Council of Chief State School Officers, 2011, p. 6).

Learner & Learning: “To ensure that each student learns new knowledge and skills, teachers must understand that learning and developmental patterns vary among individuals, that learners bring unique individual differences to the learning process, and that learners need supportive and safe learning environments to thrive” (Council of Chief State School Officers, 2011, p. 8).

The candidate:

1. Demonstrates respect for cultural differences and the beliefs of others.
2. Demonstrates patience and flexibility during the learning process.
3. Creates a challenging learning environment that demonstrates high expectations for others.
4. Develops, maintains, and models appropriate relationships within the learning environment, community, and larger diverse society.
5. Demonstrates student-centered decision-making based on student needs when planning and adjusting instruction.
6. Demonstrates critical thinking in written & oral form.

7. Demonstrates use of Evidence-Based Practices.
8. Demonstrates compliance with New York State Code of Ethics for Educators and SUNY Oneonta academic standards.
9. Demonstrates initiative and responsibility for own actions: independence, going beyond what is given, seeking after knowledge and professional development, and actively seeking solutions to problems.
10. Demonstrates professional demeanor and appearance appropriate to the situation.
11. Fosters respectful communication among all members of the learning community.
12. Is prepared for class or appointments.
13. Is punctual for class or appointments.
14. Demonstrates reflective practice in written or verbal form.

(SUNY Oneonta Student Teaching Handbook, 2017)

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5.2: Integrity

“There is no higher value in our society than integrity.” Arlen Specter

Integrity refers to a person having strong moral values. We associate people who have integrity as being honest and decent. To consistently do the “right” thing, even if nobody is watching. According to Seth Meyers, “The good news about integrity is that we’re not born with it—or without it—which means that it’s a behavior-based virtue we can cultivate over time.” (Psychology Today, 2015). Integrity is an extremely important trait to cultivate and highly valued in our society. As future teachers, you are expected to possess this characteristic and held to a higher standard than many other careers.

Activity

Read the article below and be prepared to discuss the following questions:

<http://www.csun.edu/~hfmgt001/honesty.doc>

1. List 3-5 characteristics that demonstrate integrity.
2. Think of an example that shows a person having integrity in a situation.

According to the article, how are integrity and honesty different?

Teachers and Copyright Laws

Teachers are not exempt from copyright laws, and you must be careful about the materials you use in your classroom. In the Copyright Act of 1976, Congress established guidelines for the duplication of copyright works. According to the law, teachers may make a single copy of a chapter of a book, an article, a short story, short essay or poem, a diagram, chart or picture. Educators may make multiple copies of copyrighted work for the use in classroom provided they meet specific guidelines of brevity, spontaneity and cumulative effect. Please refer to the following website for detailed guidelines:

www.custompublisher.com/blog/2007/10/11/the-guidelines-to-classroom-copying-what-are-brevity-spontaneity-and-cumulative-effect/

Teachers also need to be mindful of copyright laws involving electronic media. Pay attention to copyright laws for using videos, DVDs and software programs. Be aware that internet laws are still evolving, and it is best to check with their librarian or media specialist in your school building.

Teachers as Mandated Reporters

In 1974, Congress enacted the Child Abuse Prevention and Treatment Act, which defines child abuse and neglect as the physical or mental injury, sexual abuse, negligent treatment, or maltreatment of a child under the age of 18 by a person who is responsible for the child’s welfare under circumstances that indicate that the child’s welfare is harmed or threatened thereby. All states require teachers and school personnel to report suspected child abuse. Usually a reasonable suspicion, or a reasonable cause to believe is enough to require a teacher to report according to the law. Much more detailed information will be covered on this topic in the EDUC 213 class, you are required to take.

Teachers and Academic Freedom

Teachers have always been allowed a fair amount of academic freedom in creating and teaching their coursework. Academic freedom basically refers to the freedom of teachers to communicate information, without legal interference. So even if a teacher makes an off-color comment about their principal, the school district cannot fire that teacher. However, as previously mentioned, teachers are held to a higher code of ethics and should be mindful of what they say, print and post in social media.

Academic freedom can vary depending on what grades are being taught and where schools are located. Higher education tends to allow more academic freedom than secondary and elementary school teachers. There may be more public pressure about academic freedom of teachers in smaller, more rural schools than larger, city school districts. As future teachers, you need to be mindful of the school district you work in and pay careful attention to how you state facts versus opinions to your students.

The Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA):

The Family Education Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA), also known as the Buckley Amendment was passed by Congress in 1974. The law applies to all schools that receive funds under an applicable program of the U.S. Department of Education. This law was passed to clarify who had access to students' school records. Included in school records are personal records, grades, test scores and teachers' reports. This law mandated that schools had to share all information about students with their parents and/or legal guardians. It further required schools to explain recorded observations to parents, when requested.

FERPA gives parents certain rights with respect to their children's education records. These rights transfer to the student when he or she reaches the age of 18 or attends a school beyond the high school level. Students to whom the rights have transferred are "eligible students." (U.S. Department of Education, 2018).

If the student is not a dependent, then the student must generally provide consent for the school to disclose the information to the parents.

Legal Issues Involving and Court Cases Involving Students' Rights

Brown v Board of Education:

The famous landmark case, Brown versus the Board of Education involved a nine-year-old girl named Linda Brown when she was refused to attend an all-white elementary school in Topeka, Kansas. Oliver Brown, Linda's father was the prime plaintiff in this case. "In his lawsuit, Brown claimed that schools for black children were not equal to the white schools, and that segregation violated the so-called "equal protection clause" of the [14th Amendment](#), which holds that no state can "deny to any person within its jurisdiction the equal protection of the laws" (History 2009). The court case of Brown v. Board of Education of Topeka lasted from 1952 to 1954 and went to the United States Supreme Court. The court declared state laws establishing separate public schools for black and white students to be unconstitutional. Schools were required to be desegregated, as a result of this ruling.

In the Supreme Court decision, issued on May 17, 1954, Justice Earl Warren wrote that "in the field of public education the doctrine of 'separate but equal' has no place," as segregated schools are "inherently unequal." As a result, the Court ruled that the plaintiffs were being deprived of the equal protection of the laws guaranteed by the 14th Amendment. (USA Today, 2019).

Group Assignment

EDUCATION LEGAL ISSUES & STUDENTS' RIGHTS

1. Each group will be assigned an educational landmark case.
2. The task of each group is to teach the rest of the class about their assigned court case.
3. Minimum of two (2) research sources must be included in APA format at the end of the presentation.
4. The following questions (below) need to be fully answered and then presented, using either PowerPoint, Prezi, or Sway.
5. Presentation should be a maximum of 20 minutes with all members presenting a part of the case.
6. See evaluation for additional guidance.
7. You will receive a group grade for the written portion of this assignment and an individual grade for your individual presentation portion.
8. Please write each student's name at the bottom of the slide(s) they created and presented.

One way of finding information will be from the Milne Library. If you wish to do this, use the following guide to find your case:

- Begin at SUNY Oneonta home page
- Click Milne Library
- Click Databases
- Click "L"
- Click LexisNexis Academic
- Click Legal Research
- Click Look Up a Legal Case
- Type in full name of case (you don't need to type the citation)

- Click on name of the case (if it is highlighted)

COURT CASES

Group 1: Tinker v. Des Moines (1969) – Students Constitutional Rights and Freedom of Expression

Group 2: Goss v. Lopez (1975) – Suspension & Due Process

Group 3: Ingraham v. Wright (1977) – Corporal Punishment

Group 4: Bethel v. Fraser (1986) – Vulgar Speech

Group 5: Hazelwood v. Kuhlmeier (1988) – Newspaper Censorship

Group 6: Veronia School District v. Acton (1995) – Drug Testing

Locker, Backpack, Jacket, Purse Search

Group 7: Davis v. Monroe County Board of Education (1999) – Sexual Harassment

QUESTIONS TO ADDRESS:

- The situation that brought about the lawsuit. What? When? Where? Why?
- What was the issue the court had to decide?
- Who was the original plaintiff (person who sued)? What arguments were used to convince the courts?
- Who was the original defendant? What arguments were used to convince the court?
- What was the court ruling? What reasoning was used for the decision?
- Was there dissent (opposition)? By whom/what reasons were used for disagreeing with the majority opinion?
- What was the significance of the case at the time?
- What is the significance of the case for today's schools? To you as a future teacher?

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Chapter 6: The reflective practitioner

In her role as the Director of the Sofia Center for Professional Development at Bosque School, Sheryl Chard hosts workshops, seminars, and retreats for Bosque School faculty and other educators in the community that are heavily informed by feedback from countless educators. These innovative professional development opportunities allow teachers to connect with local experts and other educators, explore their roles in education through art and personal expression, and provide teachers with opportunities to grow in a professional environment that recognizes the indispensable role they hold in our society.



The experience in reflective teaching is that you must plunge into the doing, and try to educate yourself before you know what it is you're trying to learn.

—Donald Schön

Donald Schön (1987), a philosopher and educational researcher, makes an important observation: learning to teach often means making choices and taking actions without knowing in advance quite what you need to learn or what the consequences will be. The problem, as we have pointed out more than once, is that classroom events are often ambiguous and ambivalent, in that they usually serve more than one purpose. A teacher compliments a student's contribution to a discussion: at that moment she may be motivating the student, but also focusing classmates' thinking on key ideas. Her comment functions simultaneously as behavioral reinforcement, information, and expression of caring. At that moment complementing the student may be exactly the right thing to do. Or not: perhaps the praise causes the teacher to neglect the contributions of others, or focuses attention on factors that students cannot control, like their ability instead of their effort. In teaching, it seems, everything cuts more than one way, signifies more than

one thing. The complications can make it difficult to prepare for teaching in advance, though they also make teaching itself interesting and challenging.

The complications also mean that teachers need to learn from their own teaching by reflecting (or thinking about the significance of) their experiences. In the classrooms, students are not the only people who need to learn. So do teachers, though what teachers need to learn is less about curriculum and more about students' behavior and motivation, about how to assess their learning well, and about how to shape the class into a mutually supportive community.

Thinking about these matters begins to make a teacher a reflective practitioner, a professional who learns both from experience and about experience. Becoming thoughtful helps you in all the areas discussed in this text: it helps in understanding better how students' learning occurs, what motivates students, how you might differentiate your instruction more fully, and how you can make assessments of learning more valid and fair.

Learning to reflect on practice is so important, in fact, that we have referred to and illustrated its value throughout this book. In addition, we devote this entire appendix to how you, like other professional teachers, can develop habits of reflective practice in yourself. First, we describe what reflective practice feels like as an experience, and offer examples of places, people, and activities that can support your own reflection on practice. Then we discuss how teachers can also learn simply by observing and reflecting on their own teaching systematically, and by sharing the results with other teachers and professionals. This is an activity we mentioned in this book previously; we call it teacher research or action research. As you will see, reflective practice not only contributes to teachers' ability to make wise decisions, but also allows them to serve as effective, principled advocates on behalf of students.

Concluding activities (check for understanding)

ACTIVITY

1. Make a list of the five most important characteristics of an excellent teacher.
 - Do you possess these characteristics?
 - If not, what steps can you take to add the characteristic(s) to your teaching profile?
2. Write a paragraph of your teaching philosophy.
 - Why content is important?
 - Best way to teach?
 - What will your style be?
 - What are your goals as a teacher?

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Chapter 7: Teachers' Purposes and Beliefs

One of the main charges to teachers is to convey content to their students. Teachers need to express why the content they teach is important to learn. For elementary teachers, the necessity for students to learn how to calculate, read, and write is a given, but the answer is not as clear for other subjects: music, science, physical education, history, and art. Many parents do not see the need for their children to study a subject past a certain point. In order to ground why content is important, reflection and creation of a personal philosophy is essential.

In conveying content, teachers need to use the most effective strategies available. Different content might require a variety of approaches. Another factor to consider is if technology will enhance student understanding. Teachers with a good grasp of strategies along with a wide variety of ways to instruct students during a lesson will be more successful.

Students' mindsets indicate how well and how much they are able to learn. Psychologist Carol Dweck, (2008) defines a growth mindset as the increase in ability to learn when a learner accepts that they may improve, and this improvement will lead to increased ability to learn more. Effort is valued because effort and self-efficacy lead to knowing more and therefore having more ability to learn. Individuals with a growth mindset also ask for help when needed and respond well to constructive feedback. In contrast, individuals with a fixed mindset assume that some people naturally have more ability than others and nothing can be done to change that. Individuals with a fixed mindset often view effort in opposition to ability ("Smart people don't have to study") and so do not try as hard and are less likely to ask for help since they believe that asking questions indicates that they are not smart. There are individual differences in students' beliefs about their views of intelligence. However, teachers' beliefs and classroom practices influence these students' perceptions, behaviors, and willingness to adopt a growth mindset.

Teachers with a growth mindset believe that the goal of learning is mastering the material and figuring things out. Assessment is used by these teachers to understand what students know so they can decide whether to move to the next topic, re-teach the entire class, or provide remediation for a few students. Assessment also helps students understand their own learning and demonstrate their competence. Teachers with these views say things like, "We are going to practice over and over again. That's how you get good. And you're going to make mistakes. That's how you learn" (Patrick, Anderman, Ryan, Edelin, & Midgley, 2001, p. 45).

In contrast, teachers with a fixed mindset are more likely to believe that the goal of learning is doing well on tests – and especially outperforming others. These teachers are more likely to say things that imply fixed abilities such as, "This test will determine what your math abilities are," or stress the importance of interpersonal competition, "We will have speech competition and the top person will compete against all the other district schools and last year the winner got a big award and their photo in the paper." When teachers stress competition some students will be motivated; however, there can only a few winners so there are many more students who believe they have no chance of winning. Another problem with competition as an assessment is that the focus can become winning rather than understanding the material.

Teachers who view assessment as promoting and developing learning rather than as a means of ranking students, or awarding prizes to those who did very well, or catching those who did not pay attention, are likely to enhance student willingness to identify and correct gaps in learning and understanding.

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Chapter 8: Lifelong learning and professional development

Teachers engage in the process of lifelong learning as a way to meet the needs of their students, respond to best practices in the literature and research and try to integrate the newly acquired approaches to support student learning. Some examples of lifelong learning, also known as professional development, may be attendance at a conference, mentoring (either as the mentee or mentor), joining a professional organization and conducting research. As an undergraduate student pursuing your Bachelors Degree in education you are immersed in a constant environment of learning.

New York state has teacher induction requirements for first-year teachers. As a first-year teacher in New York State, you will be assigned a mentor in your district who will serve to support and guide you through the challenges, questions, and joys that your first year of teaching will offer. Strong mentor-mentee programs increase the development of a new teacher's connection to the school community and reduce isolations (NYSED, 2013).

ACTIVITY: THINK IT, INK IT

Think it, Ink it (5 minutes) and divide into groups of 4-5 students and share your answers.

1. As a first-year teacher what personal qualities would you hope for in a mentor?
2. What specific type of information do you want your mentor to provide you with?
3. How will you advocate for your needs as a first-year teacher/ mentee?

Report out to the class the results of the group's conversation.

Resources for professional development and learning

At some level reflection on practice is something you must do for yourself, since only you have had your particular teaching experiences, and only you can choose how to interpret and make use of them. But this individual activity also may benefit from the stimulus and challenge offered by fellow professionals. Others' ideas may differ from your own, and they can, therefore, help in working out your own thoughts and in alerting you to ideas that you may otherwise take for granted. These benefits of reflection can happen in any number of ways, but most fall into one of four general categories:

- talking and collaborating with colleagues
- participating in professional associations
- attending professional development workshops and conferences
- reading professional literature

Many teacher education preparation programs follow the INTASC Standards developed by the Council of Chief State School Officers. Standard nine outlines professional learning and ethical practice. Below you will find the exact excerpt from Standard 9. Notice Some of the relevant aspects are using data and evidence to support and evaluate classroom practices. Another key component to lifelong learning is engaging in ongoing reflective practice. Reflection is a hallmark of instructional leaders and assists teachers in meeting a diverse range of student needs.

Standard #9: Professional Learning and Ethical Practice

The teacher engages in ongoing professional learning and uses evidence to continually evaluate his/her practice, particularly the effects of his/her choices and actions on others (learners, families, other professionals, and the community, and adapts practice to meet the needs of each learner.

PERFORMANCES

9(a) The teacher engages in ongoing learning opportunities to develop knowledge and skills in order to provide all learners with engaging curriculum and learning experiences based on local and state standards.

9(b) The teacher engages in meaningful and appropriate professional learning experiences aligned with his/her own needs and the needs of the learners, school, and system.

9(c) Independently and in collaboration with colleagues, the teacher uses a variety of data (e.g., systematic observation, information about learners, research) to evaluate the outcomes of teaching and learning and to adapt planning and practice.

9(d) The teacher actively seeks professional, community, and technological resources, within and outside the school, as supports for analysis, reflection, and problem-solving.

9(e) The teacher reflects on his/her personal biases and accesses resources to deepen his/her own understanding of cultural, ethnic, gender, and learning differences to build stronger relationships and create more relevant learning experiences.

9(f) The teacher advocates, models, and teaches safe, legal, and ethical use of information and technology including appropriate documentation of sources and respect for others in the use of social media.

ESSENTIAL KNOWLEDGE

9(g) The teacher understands and knows how to use a variety of selfassessment and problem-solving strategies to analyze and reflect on his/her practice and to plan for adaptations/adjustments.

9(h) The teacher knows how to use learner data to analyze practice and differentiate instruction accordingly.

9(i) The teacher understands how personal identity, worldview, and prior experience affect perceptions and expectations, and recognizes how they may bias behaviors and interactions with others.

9(j) The teacher understands laws related to learners' rights and teacher responsibilities (e.g., for educational equity, appropriate education for learners with disabilities, confidentiality, privacy, appropriate treatment of learners, reporting in situations related to possible child abuse).

9(k) The teacher knows how to build and implement a plan for professional growth directly aligned with his/her needs as a growing professional using feedback from teacher evaluations and observations, data on learner performance, and school- and systemwide priorities.

CRITICAL DISPOSITIONS

9(l) The teacher takes responsibility for student learning and uses ongoing analysis and reflection to improve planning and practice.

9(m) The teacher is committed to deepening understanding of his/her own frames of reference (e.g., culture, gender, language, abilities, ways of knowing), the potential biases in these frames, and their impact on expectations for and relationships with learners and their families.

9(n) The teacher sees him/herself as a learner, continuously seeking opportunities to draw upon current education policy and research as sources of analysis and reflection to improve practice.

9(o) The teacher understands the expectations of the profession including codes of ethics, professional standards of practice, and relevant law and policy

Activity: How do you plan to integrate reflection into your practice as a teacher? How does reflection connect to teacher induction and mentor programs?

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